Tools are functions

AI agents · Upper secondary · Lesson 2



In this lesson you will

- Write a tool as a Python function.
- Send each call to the right tool with a dictionary.
- Return errors instead of crashing or guessing.

Key ideas

- A tool takes details and returns a result, both as dictionaries.
- TOOLS maps each tool’s name to its function.
- An unknown tool, a missing detail, an unknown place: each gets an error result.

Activity: Be the tools

1. Warm-up (3 min): What should happen when the model asks for “bus”?
2. Cards (7 min): Each friend is one tool, with its details on a card.
3. Calls (6 min): A caller reads calls; the right tool answers, or says an error.
4. Code (4 min): Try the bus call on run() in the code step.

Use made-up villages, classes and books only, such as Kafi, Dala and 6B. The card game needs no devices.

Let’s discuss

1. Why is a guess worse than an error?
2. How would you add a new tool to TOOLS?
3. Which details would you check inside each tool?

Exit ticket

- Write one call that should return an error, and the error it returns.